EXECUTIVE & STRATEGIC 2×2 DECISION MATRIX EDITION (AGES 12+)



TOPS AND BOTTOMS

A Classic Harvest Fable on Knowledge, Honest Work, and Fair Agreements

By Zinaida Jupiter, DBA • Published by Jupiter Group LLC

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Why Every Classic Fable Holds Two Golden Keys

Every classic folk tale carries two golden keys inside its imagery. When a child (ages 6+) listens to *TOPS AND BOTTOMS* in the evening, they discover how character, honesty, and foresight work without a single dry lecture. And when a parent, founder, or executive (12+) reads the very same story, they recognize timeless negotiation and governance patterns laid out clearly across our **2×2 Decision Matrix**—where the winning choice always shines in **★ Quadrant 4 (Top-Right Corner)**.

Cross-Cultural Bridge: Connects with the European folk tale 'The Peasant and the Devil' (Brothers Grimm) and classic Asian agricultural parables on domain competence.

Proverb of the Book: *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

Zinaida Jupiter, DBA
Creator of the Jupiter Wisdom Tales Series & 2×2 Decision Matrix Methodology

❧ SHEET I. THE SPRING CLEARING AND THE BEAR'S BARGAIN ❧



Early one spring a hardworking Farmer rode out to a sunny forest clearing to plough the soil and plant sweet golden turnips. No sooner had he cut the first furrow than the great Brown Bear stepped out of the oak woods and roared: 'Farmer! Why are you ploughing in my forest? I shall crush your cart!'

Taking off his cap calmly, the clever Farmer replied: 'Do not be angry, Master Bear! Let us farm this field as partners: I shall plough, sow, and tend the crop all summer, and in autumn we shall divide the harvest fairly. Tell me now—who takes the Tops, and who takes the Bottoms?' Thinking that whatever grows above ground in the sun must be finest, the Bear boomed: 'The Tops for me, and the Bottoms for you!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

❧ SHEET II. AUTUMN TURNIPS: LUSH LEAVES VS. SWEET ROOTS ❧



All summer long the Farmer weeded and watered the field while the Bear napped in the shade. By autumn the turnips had grown round, heavy, and sweet as amber beneath the soil.

When the Bear arrived to claim his share, the Farmer honestly cut every green leaf and piled a mountain of turnip tops onto the Bear's cart, while loading the firm golden turnip roots onto his own wagon.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

❧ SHEET III. A BITE OF BITTER GREENS ON THE FOREST STUMP ❧



Sitting on a mossy stump, the Bear chewed his green tops—and frowned, for turnip leaves are tough and bitter! Just then the Farmer rode past eating a fragrant steamed turnip.

Tasting one sweet slice, the Bear roared: 'Your bottoms are sweet as honey, while my tops are bitter! Next spring when you plant this clearing, you shall give me the Bottoms and keep the Tops for yourself!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *“He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life.”*

❧ SHEET IV. SEASON TWO: GOLDEN WHEAT UNDER THE SUMMER SUN ❧



The following spring the Farmer returned to the same clearing—but this time he sowed golden wheat instead of turnips. By August the field stood like a rustling sea of heavy amber ears.

Out marched the Bear, pointing his paw at the ground: 'Remember our new contract, Farmer! Last year I lost on the tops—this time give me every Bottom in the earth, and take the Tops for yourself!' The Farmer bowed: 'As you command, Master Bear!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

❧ SHEET V. FULL SHEAVES OF GRAIN AND THE WISDOM OF FAIR SHARING ❧



Together they reaped the field: the Farmer gathered the rich, grain-filled wheat ears—the Tops—and baked warm white loaves for his family, while the Bear was left with dry, prickly wheat roots in the dirt.

From this classic harvest tale, wise families and partners learn a double truth: first, always understand the nature of the work before signing a deal; second, the strongest partnership lasts for years when both sides share both the labour and the sweet harvest fairly!

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who knows the root of the craft reaps the golden grain; he who shares by honest work keeps a friend for life."*

Three Evening Questions for Parents & Children

- **1. Why did the Bear choose the wrong half twice in a row?**
  Did he take the time to learn how turnips and wheat grow, or did he just shout loudly and demand the biggest-looking pile?
- **2. Why is real knowledge stronger than a loud roar?**
  How did the Farmer's knowledge of plants and daily work help him stay calm in front of the huge Bear?
- **3. How do true friends share a harvest?**
  If the Bear had helped water the field and asked to share the real fruit fairly, how could both neighbours have feasted together?

Interactive Choice Game: “Three Roads”

Situation: *You and your sibling or classmate are making a poster for school. One of you wants to do none of the drawing or reading, but demands to take the whole prize home.*

Path 1 (The Bear's Loud Demand): Shout 'I get the best part!' without helping or understanding the task.

Path 2 (Sly Trickery Between Friends): Trick your friend with a confusing rule so they get nothing and never trust you again.

★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (Honest Work & Fair Halves!): Divide both the work and the reward fairly from the start so both partners are proud and happy!

❖ **Creative Task: Draw what grows underground (sweet turnips and carrots—Bottoms!) and what ripens in the sun (golden wheat ears—Tops!)!**
24-Hour Family Habit: Show your child a carrot and a tomato tonight: ask which grows underground and which ripens in the sun—celebrating curiosity and real knowledge!

VERTICAL AXIS Y ↑: KNOWLEDGE OF THE CRAFT & DILIGENCE → | HORIZONTAL AXIS X ►: HONESTY & FAIR SHARING IN THE FAMILY

Lesson II • Clever Defense Alone (Upper-Left: Y+, X–) The Farmer saves his harvest with wit, yet without fair cooperation no lasting friendship forms.	**★ UNION OF KNOWLEDGE, WORK & FAIRNESS** (★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING CHOICE: Y+, X+) Deep understanding of the task combined with shared effort and fair division of the fruit.
Lesson I • The Bear's Lazy Roar (Lower-Left: Y–, X–) Demanding the best share loudly while refusing both to work and to learn how things grow.	**Lesson III • Blindly Repeating Yesterday's Rule** (Lower-Right: Y–, X+) Trying to follow rules while copying yesterday's answer when the crop has already changed.

Two Golden Vows of the Tale:

1. Learn how the world works from root to crown: Curiosity, reading, and craft protect you from foolish mistakes.

2. Share both the effort and the joy: In a loving family and team, whoever helps plant and tend the garden shares the sweetest fruit.

Who Is Who in Business, Governance & Negotiations

- **1. The Farmer — Domain Expert & Operational Architect:** Possesses deep technical know-how and executes 100% of the fieldwork, using information asymmetry to survive a coercive partner.
- **2. The Bear — Capital/Power Holder With Zero Domain Due Diligence:** Uses positional dominance ('my forest') to dictate contract terms without understanding where EBITDA is actually generated.
- **3. Season One ('Turnips') — The Gross Revenue Illusion:** Taking flashy top-line turnover ('green tops') while the operational partner retains net cash flow and IP ('sweet roots').
- **4. Season Two ('Wheat') — Mechanical Extrapolation of Past Rules:** Blindly copying last year's contract clause into a new market model and losing the entire harvest a second time.

Strategic Traps & The ★ Quadrant 4 Solution

Trap 1 — Dictating Contract Terms Without Understanding the Value Chain: Demanding 'Tops' or 'Bottoms' by force when you have not audited whether the asset is a root crop or grain.

Trap 2 — Winning Round One by Clever Wording and Losing the Venture in Round Two: If a contract relies on a hidden catch, the counterparty will exit in rage—destroying long-term compounding.

★ The Quadrant 4 Solution — Transparent Value-Chain SLA & Joint Venture Alignment: Define the exact economic metric (Net Distributable Profit / IP) and align rewards with each partner's real contribution.

AXIS Y ↑: DOMAIN MASTERY & VALUE-CHAIN CLARITY → | AXIS X ►: FAIRNESS & TRANSPARENCY OF CONTRACT (ONE-SIDED COERCION OR TRICK → FAIR WIN-WIN EQUITY SPLIT)

Quadrant 2 • Tactical Outsmarting
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
You win one harvest through contract wording, but turn your partner into a permanent enemy.

★ SUSTAINABLE JOINT VENTURE
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING QUADRANT: Y+, X+)
Full transparency on where value ripens + fair profit-sharing tied to real contribution.

Quadrant 1 • The Bear's Blindness
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Bullying negotiations without domain knowledge—ending up with bitter leaves and dry roots.

Quadrant 3 • Naive Good Intentions
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Friendly handshake without auditing unit economics—both sides harvest weeds.

Executive Vocabulary & Boardroom Action Phrases

Idiom	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Quadrant 4 Action
"Are we buying Tops or Bottoms here?"	Do we understand where the real net margin and IP live in this deal, or are we looking at vanity foliage?	**★ Run a unit-economics audit before signing.**
"Don't fight the last season's turnip war"	We are applying an old rule to a completely new business model ('wheat instead of turnips').	**★ Re-verify assumptions for the current market cycle.**
"A one-season trick kills a ten-year partnership"	Clever fine print that hurts our partner today will cost us the alliance tomorrow.	**★ Rewrite the clause so both sides win on the core metric.**
"Share the grain, not the chaff"	Tie executive and partner incentives to verified net value created.	**★ Align KPIs with net cash flow and customer retention.**

International Contract & Governance Standard:
Joint Venture Specification Schedule; Deliverable Definition by Measurable Output; Pre-Investment Technical Due Diligence.

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